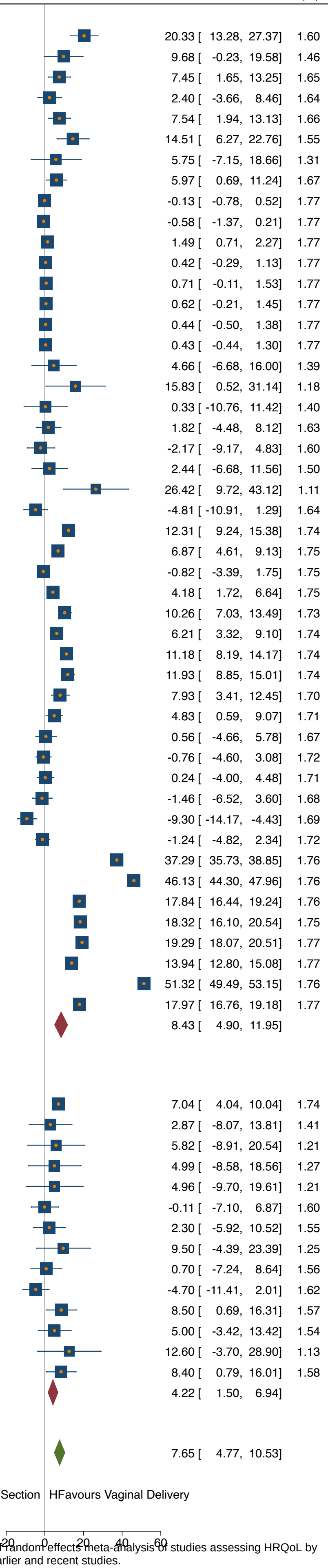
Study	Vaginal Delivery N	Mean	SD	Caesarean Section N	Mean	SD	Mean diff. with 95% CI	Weight (%)
Earlier studies								
Jansen 2007 (PF)	71	59.40	20.70	70	39.07	21.95	20.33 [13.28, 27.37]	1.60
Jansen 2007 (PR)	71	26.90	35.00	70	17.22	23.90	9.68 [-0.23, 19.58]	1.46
Jansen 2007 (BP)	71	44.70	16.10	70	37.25	18.94	7.45 [1.65, 13.25]	1.65
Jansen 2007 (GH)	71	76.50	17.10	70	74.10	19.55	2.40 [-3.66, 8.46]	1.64
Jansen 2007 (V)	71	55.80	16.70	70	48.26	17.20	7.54 [1.94, 13.13]	1.66
Jansen 2007 (SF)	71	64.60	24.40	70	50.09	25.57	14.51 [6.27, 22.76]	1.55
Jansen 2007 (ER)	71	70.40	36.40	70	64.65	41.66	5.75 [-7.15, 18.66]	1.31
Jansen 2007 (MH)	71	81.90	15.40	70	75.93	16.54	5.97 [0.69, 11.24]	1.67
Hutton 2015 (PF)	856	51.51	7.67	1,711	51.64	8.10	-0.13 [-0.78, 0.52]	1.77
Hutton 2015 (PR)	856	46.40	9.63	1,711	46.98	9.70	-0.58 [-1.37, 0.21]	1.77
Hutton 2015 (BP)	856	52.91	9.60	1,711	51.42	9.53	1.49 [0.71, 2.27]	1.77
Hutton 2015 (GH)	856	53.20	7.95	1,711	52.78	9.03	0.42 [-0.29, 1.13]	1.77
Hutton 2015 (V)	856	51.21	9.82	1,711	50.50	10.10	0.71 [-0.11, 1.53]	1.77
Hutton 2015 (SF)	856	46.40	10.03	1,711	45.78	10.10	0.62 [-0.21, 1.45]	1.77
Hutton 2015 (ER)	856	44.76	11.20	1,711	44.32	11.56	0.44 [-0.50, 1.38]	1.77
Hutton 2015 (MH)	856	49.66	10.46	1,711	49.23	10.66	0.43 [-0.44, 1.30]	1.77
Kavosi 2015 (PF)	59	64.17	30.11	39	59.51	24.54	4.66 [-6.68, 16.00]	1.39
Kavosi 2015 (PR)	59	52.08	41.75	39	36.25	30.98	15.83 [0.52, 31.14]	1.18
Kavosi 2015 (BP)	59	57.98	29.31	39	57.65	24.25	0.33 [-10.76, 11.42]	1.40
Kavosi 2015 (GH)	59	60.83	16.67	39	59.01	13.76	1.82 [-4.48, 8.12]	1.63
Kavosi 2015 (V)	59	60.83	20.96	39	63.00	9.32	-2.17 [-9.17, 4.83]	1.60
Kavosi 2015 (SF)	59	63.97	24.41	39	61.53	19.33	2.44 [-6.68, 11.56]	1.50
Kavosi 2015 (ER)	59	53.87	44.75	39	27.45	35.34	26.42 [9.72, 43.12]	1.11
Kavosi 2015 (MH)	59	64.20	15.80	39	69.01	13.91	-4.81 [-10.91, 1.29]	1.64
AlShehri 2015 (PF)	75	51.23	2.72	75	38.92	13.28	12.31 [9.24, 15.38]	1.74
AlShehri 2015 (PR)	75	50.24	5.83	75	43.37	8.13	6.87 [4.61, 9.13]	1.75
AlShehri 2015 (BP)	75	49.24	5.83	75	50.06	9.74	-0.82 [-3.39, 1.75]	1.75
AlShehri 2015 (GH)	75	51.68	6.79	75	47.50	8.46	4.18 [1.72, 6.64]	1.75
AlShehri 2015 (V)	75	61.76	10.68	75	51.50	9.45	10.26 [7.03, 13.49]	1.73
AlShehri 2015 (SF)	75	48.66	7.54	75	42.45	10.30	6.21 [3.32, 9.10]	1.74
AlShehri 2015 (ER)	75	50.82	6.87	75	39.64	11.31	11.18 [8.19, 14.17]	1.74
AlShehri 2015 (MH)	75	56.01	9.16	75	44.08	10.09	11.93 [8.85, 15.01]	1.74
Sedat 2013 (PF)	150	61.06	19.80	150	53.13	20.18	7.93 [3.41, 12.45]	1.70
Sedat 2013 (PR)	150	55.95	18.11	150	51.12	19.33	4.83 [0.59, 9.07]	1.71
Sedat 2013 (BP)	150	59.01	23.35	150	58.45	22.74	0.56 [-4.66, 5.78]	1.67
Sedat 2013 (GH)	150	66.04	17.23	150	66.80	16.67	-0.76 [-4.60, 3.08]	1.72
Sedat 2013 (V)	150	59.90	18.55	150	59.66	18.88	0.24 [-4.00, 4.48]	1.71
Sedat 2013 (SF)	150	60.70	22.90	150	62.16	21.76	-1.46 [-6.52, 3.60]	1.68
Sedat 2013 (ER)	150	57.22	24.09	150	66.52	18.57	-9.30 [-14.17, -4.43]	1.69
Sedat 2013 (MH)	150	60.28	16.60	150	61.52	14.97	-1.24 [-4.82, 2.34]	1.72
Majzoobi 2014 (PF)	2,100	72.23	21.35	2,100	34.94	29.55	37.29 [35.73, 38.85]	1.76
Majzoobi 2014 (PR)	2,100	69.71	34.20	2,100	23.58	25.65	46.13 [44.30, 47.96]	1.76
Majzoobi 2014 (BP)	2,100	67.84	22.86	2,100	50.00	23.58	17.84 [16.44, 19.24]	1.76
Majzoobi 2014 (GH)	2,100	69.89	16.51	2,100	51.57	49.31	18.32 [16.10, 20.54]	1.75
Majzoobi 2014 (V)	2,100	61.99	15.47	2,100	42.70	24.07	19.29 [18.07, 20.51]	1.77
Majzoobi 2014 (SF)	2,100	72.14	19.22	2,100	58.20	18.45	13.94 [12.80, 15.08]	1.77
Majzoobi 2014 (ER)	2,100	73.82	30.39	2,100	22.50	29.96	51.32 [49.49, 53.15]	1.76
Majzoobi 2014 (MH)	2,100	73.54	19.23	2,100	55.57	20.87	17.97 [16.76, 19.18]	1.77
Heterogeneity: τ^2 = 147.04, I^2 = 99.52%, H^2 = 207.94							8.43 [4.90, 11.95]	
Test of $\theta_i = \theta_j$: Q(47) = 8961.29, p = 0.00								
Recent studies								
Angelini 2018 (GH)	278	67.89	20.46	499	60.85	20.49	7.04 [4.04, 10.04]	1.74
Foblets 2018 (PF)	275	80.49	58.86	605	77.62	83.59	2.87 [-8.07, 13.81]	1.41
Foblets 2018 (BP)	275	74.27	79.27	605	68.45	112.55	5.82 [-8.91, 20.54]	1.21
Foblets 2018 (V)	275	50.51	73.13	605	45.52	103.66	4.99 [-8.58, 18.56]	1.27
Foblets 2018 (SF)	275	75.96	79.00	605	71.00	111.96	4.96 [-9.70, 19.61]	1.21
Foblets 2018 (MH)	275	49.30	37.61	605	49.42	53.34	-0.11 [-7.10, 6.87]	1.60
Torkan 2019 (PF)	50	79.50	23.00	50	77.20	18.70	2.30 [-5.92, 10.52]	1.55
Torkan 2019 (PR)	50	42.50	37.20	50	33.00	33.60	9.50 [-4.39, 23.39]	1.25
Torkan 2019 (BP)	50	62.80	20.10	50	62.10	20.40	0.70 [-7.24, 8.64]	1.56
Torkan 2019 (GH)	50	73.10	19.00	50	77.80	15.00	-4.70 [-11.41, 2.01]	1.62
Torkan 2019 (V)	50	62.90	17.60	50	54.40	22.00	8.50 [0.69, 16.31]	1.57
Torkan 2019 (SF)	50	68.20	19.60	50	63.20	23.20	5.00 [-3.42, 13.42]	1.54
Torkan 2019 (ER)	50	50.60	45.30	50	38.00	37.50	12.60 [-3.70, 28.90]	1.13
Torkan 2019 (MH)	50	75.10	16.80	50	66.70	21.70	8.40 [0.79, 16.01]	1.58
Heterogeneity: τ^2 = 7.39, I^2 = 31.30%, H^2 = 1.46							4.22 [1.50, 6.94]	
Test of $\theta_i = \theta_j$: Q(13) = 16.30, p = 0.23								
Overall							7.65 [4.77, 10.53]	
Heterogeneity: τ^2 = 122.19, I^2 = 99.26%, H^2 = 135.66								
Test of $\theta_i = \theta_j$: Q(61) = 8978.54, p = 0.00								
Test of group differences: $Q_b(1)$ = 3.43, p = 0.06								



Random-effects REML model

Supplementary Figure 3: Forest plot of random effects meta-analysis of studies assessing HRQoL by SF-36 dimension score, stratified by earlier and recent studies.